

KDL Tracker — Complete Operator Guide

KDL Tracker is the web application Kingdao Logistics uses to manage import consignments from vessel arrival, through customs clearance, to final release. It replaces the company's old shared Excel workbook (`TRACKER_--_KDL.xlsx`) with a structured, multi-user system: real-time pipeline views, role-based access, audit history, and one-click reports.

Who this guide is for: people who are **completely new** — to shipping, to customs clearance, and to this app. You do **not** need any prior logistics knowledge. By the end you will understand *what the business does, why each step exists, how to use every screen, and how this app improves on the spreadsheet it replaced*. If you later want to know how the software is built (database, security, architecture), read [doc.md](#) .

How to read this guide: If you're brand new, read sections 1–3 slowly — they teach the shipping world. Then section 6 is your hands-on “how do I actually do my job” walkthrough. Sections 9 and 11 explain the old Excel sheet and why the app is better. Skim the rest as needed.

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1. What Kingdao does (in plain English)

The problem we solve

A business in Tanzania — say a motorcycle dealer or a steel factory — buys goods from overseas (often China). Those goods are packed into steel **shipping containers**, loaded onto a giant **cargo ship** (the *vessel*), and sailed across the ocean to the **Port of Dar es Salaam**.

Here is the part most people don't realise: **a container cannot just roll off the ship and drive to the buyer**. The Tanzanian government has to be satisfied first. Several different agencies are involved, each with its own forms, fees, and checks:

- **TRA** (Tanzania Revenue Authority) — the tax office. It decides how much **import duty** (tax) the goods owe and collects it.
- **TBS** (Tanzania Bureau of Standards) — checks the goods are safe and legal to sell, and charges a standards fee.
- **The port and the ICDs** (inland container depots) — the physical yards where containers sit while all this happens.
- **TANESWS** (the electronic "single window") — the government website where all the documents get filed.

Only after every box is ticked does the government issue a **Release Order**, and *only then* can the container leave the yard on a truck.

Where Kingdao fits

Most importers don't know how to navigate all of that, and they don't have the time. So they hire a **customs clearing and forwarding agent** — that's us, **Kingdao Logistics (KDL)**, based in Dar es Salaam. We are the experts who:

1. Receive the shipping documents from the importer.
2. File everything with the right agencies, in the right order.
3. Pay the duties and fees on the client's behalf.
4. Arrange the inspection.
5. Get the **Release Order** and hand the goods over.
6. Send the client a bill (and an official tax receipt — the **EDF**) for our service.

We do this for **one shipment at a time**. Each shipment we're hired to clear is called a **consignment** — that is the single most important word in this app. A consignment is one job, one folder, one row. It might be one container, a batch of six containers, or a single imported car.

Why speed is money

Here is the pressure that makes this whole app worth building: **while a container sits in a yard waiting to clear, the client is charged daily penalty fees.** These are called **demurrage** (charged by the shipping line) and **storage** (charged by the depot). They add up fast. If a job gets *stuck* — waiting on a payment, a document, an inspection — every extra day costs the client real money, and they hold KDL responsible for the delay.

So the entire job of this tracker is to answer three questions, instantly, for all ~400+ jobs we handle per year:

1. **Where is every shipment right now?** (Which step is it on?)
2. **What is blocking it?** (What needs to happen next?)
3. **Who is working on it?** (Whose job is the next step?)

The old answer to those questions was “scroll through a giant spreadsheet.” The new answer is this app.

2. Shipping 101 — jargon buster

You will hear these terms constantly. Learn them once and the rest of the app makes sense.

Term	Meaning	Simple analogy
Consignment	One clearance job in the system	A folder for one shipment you are clearing
REF No	Internal reference, 7 digits (e.g. 9900001)	KDL's own job number, like a ticket number
B/L (Bill of Lading)	The shipping line's document number	The carrier's "tracking number" for that cargo
TANSAD No	Tanzania Single Administrative Document number	The official customs declaration — the shipment's "tax form"
Vessel	The cargo ship	How the goods physically arrived
ICD	Inland Container Depot	A secure yard where containers wait (e.g. African ICD, Galco, Hesu, DP World)
IN REF	Invoice reference (e.g. TZ3 , HB2)	A code that groups several B/Ls onto one combined invoice
EFD	Electronic Fiscal Device receipt	The official TRA fiscal receipt for KDL's service fee
Manifest	The ship's official cargo list	Must exist before clearance can even start
TANESWS	Tanzania Electronic Single Window System	The government portal where documents are filed
Assessment	TRA's duty calculation step	Customs decides how much tax the client owes
TBS	Tanzania Bureau of Standards	Standards compliance system and fees
Duty	Import tax	The main customs tax payment
Release	Government permission to leave the depot	The finish line — goods can go to the client
Demurrage / storage	Daily penalty fees for delay	The reason a "stuck" job is an emergency

Container types you'll see in the app: 40FT (a 40-foot container), 20FT (a 20-foot container), CAR (a single private vehicle), and COIL (steel coils, counted by the coil, not the box).

A note on REF numbers: KDL's internal job numbers are 7 digits and start with 99 (e.g. 9900042). If an old record has a shorter number, the importer pads it with leading 9 s and flags it for a human to double-check.

3. The 10-stage clearance pipeline

Every consignment moves through **ten pipeline stages**, in order — like a board game where the token must land on every square from start to finish. Each stage has a **status** that progresses:

- **Waiting** (grey) — not started yet.
- **Action** (amber) — someone is actively working on it *right now*.
- A **done value** (green) — the stage is complete. The exact word differs per stage (e.g. *Uploaded, Closed, Paid, Released*).

EFD is not a pipeline stage. The official fiscal receipt (EFD) is handled *separately*, after release, in the **EFD Records** section. It is not a column on the Kanban board. (Some older docs describe an “11th stage” — that was just a simplification; in the app, EFD lives on its own.)

flowchart TD

```
manifest[1. Manifest] --> shipping[2. Shipping Batch]
shipping --> tanesws[3. TANESWS]
tanesws --> assessment[4. Assessment]
assessment --> tbsLoad[5. TBS Loading]
tbsLoad --> tbsDebit[6. TBS Debit]
tbsDebit --> manifestComp[7. Manifest Comp]
manifestComp --> duty[8. Duty]
duty --> inspection[9. Inspection File]
inspection --> release[10. Release]
```

Stage-by-stage — what each step means in the real world

#	Stage	What actually happens	"Done" value
1	Manifest	The ship files its official cargo list with customs. Nothing can start until this list is uploaded.	Uploaded
2	Shipping Batch	The container is moved from the crowded port to an inland depot (ICD) and settled there (the "carry-in").	Done (may pass through <i>PREPARED</i> , <i>W/CARRY IN</i> , <i>CARRY IN END</i>)
3	TANESWS	KDL logs into the government single-window portal and files the cargo documents to begin clearance.	Done
4	Assessment	TRA reviews the documents and calculates the duty owed. Once the figure is locked, it is <i>Closed</i> .	Closed
5	TBS Loading	The shipment's data is entered into the standards-bureau system.	Done
6	TBS Debit	The TBS standards fee is paid.	Paid (may be <i>SHARED</i> across a batch)
7	Manifest Comp	The customs paperwork is finalised and matched to the physical cargo.	Done
8	Duty	The main import duty (from stage 4) is paid.	Paid
9	Inspection File	Customs officers physically inspect the cargo to confirm it matches the documents.	Done
10	Release	The government issues the Release Order. Gates open, trucks load, goods leave the depot.	Released

After release, finance records the **EFD** fiscal receipt against the consignment in the EFD Records section — closing the financial loop.

Rules you cannot skip

The **database itself** enforces real-world order — not just the buttons on the screen. This means even a clever user who tries to bypass the app cannot break the sequence. For example:

- You **cannot** finish **TANESWS** until **Manifest** is uploaded.
- You **cannot** pay **TBS Debit** until **Assessment** is closed.
- You **cannot Release** until **Inspection File** is done.

Going backward (undoing a completed stage) is blocked for normal operators. Only an **admin** can force a backward move, and they must type a **reason** that is saved forever in the audit log. This prevents quiet mistakes and creates accountability.

Before the ship arrives: If a consignment has no **arrival date** yet, the app treats it as **Awaiting arrival** and keeps it parked in the waiting bucket. You cannot advance stages until arrival is recorded — because in the real world, you can't clear cargo that hasn't docked.

4. Getting started — your first login

1. **Get your URL and account** from an administrator. (For local development: run `pnpm dev` and open <http://localhost:3000>.)
2. Open the app — if you're not signed in, it sends you to **Login**.
3. Enter your **email** and **password**. There is **no public sign-up** — admins invite users. This is intentional: it keeps financial data locked down.
4. After login, use the **sidebar** on the left. On a phone, tap the menu button (**Open navigation menu**) to reveal it.
5. **Know your role** — it controls what you can see and edit:

Role	Typical user	What you can do
Admin	Owner / manager	Everything: manage users and roles, force stage moves (with a reason), delete consignments, all reports
Operator	Clearing staff	Create and update consignments, advance pipeline stages, use Inbox, EFD, and Import
Viewer	Read-only / client-facing	View consignments and reports; cannot drag cards or change any stage

Admins can also define **custom roles** with **per-column permissions** — for example, a junior operator who may edit the manifest stage but cannot see or change the `amount` (service fee). See <docs/permissions.md>.

5. Sidebar map — every screen explained

Nav label	Route	Who sees it	What it's for
Dashboard	/dashboard	Everyone	KPIs, pipeline funnel, arrivals this week, overdue/stuck jobs
Pipeline	/	Everyone	Kanban board (desktop) or Triage list (mobile) of active jobs
Consignments	/consignments	Everyone	Searchable table of all jobs; filters and pagination
Inbox	/inbox	Admin, Operator	Your personal queue: stages in Action that <i>you</i> are allowed to update
EFD Records	/efd	Admin, Operator	Create and manage fiscal receipt codes; link them to consignments
Import	/import	Admin, Operator	Upload the legacy Excel tracker for preview and one-time migration
Reports	/reports	Everyone	Revenue, volume, turnaround, bottlenecks; export XLSX/PDF
Settings	/settings	Admin only	Invite users; manage roles and per-column permissions

Sign out via the footer control at the bottom of the sidebar.

6. Day-to-day workflows (step by step)

This is the practical heart of the guide. If you only read one section, read this one.

A. Start your shift (operator)

1. Open **Dashboard**.
2. Glance at **Released today**, **Pending release**, and **Stuck > 48h** (clicking these jumps to a filtered consignment list).
3. Open **Inbox** — your focused to-do list. It shows *only* stages in **Action** that you have permission to write. Nothing here that isn't yours.
4. Click **Open** → on a row (or tap the card on mobile) to open the consignment.
5. Update the active stage from the **Pipeline** tab or the stage action menu.

B. Move a job forward (three ways)

There are three ways to advance a stage. They all do the same thing — pick whichever fits your device and habit.

Option 1 — Kanban board (desktop, screen width $\geq$ 768px)

1. Go to **Pipeline**.
2. Make sure the **Kanban** tab is selected (desktop also has a **Triage** tab).
3. Find the card in the column for its current stage.
4. **Drag the card one column to the right** — this marks the current stage complete and advances it one step.
5. Dragging **backward** is **admin only** — you'll be prompted to enter a reason.

Option 2 — Triage (the default on phones, also a desktop tab)

1. Go to **Pipeline** (on a phone you land on **Triage** automatically).
2. Open the **Action Needed** section — stuck jobs appear first with a **STUCK** badge.
3. **Tap a row** — a bottom drawer slides up.
4. Use **Mark {Stage} {DoneValue}** (e.g. "Mark Manifest Uploaded") or **Set to Action**.
5. Tap **Open detail** → if you need the full record.

Option 3 — Consignment detail

1. Open any consignment → **Pipeline** tab.
2. Use the stage menu on the active (incomplete) stage — the same buttons as Triage, including intermediate values like *PREPARED*.

C. Create a new consignment

1. Go to **Consignments** → **New consignment**, or **Pipeline** → **New**.
2. Fill the required fields: **Client** and **Year**.
3. Add the logistics fields as you know them: B/L, TANSAD, vessel name, **arrival date**, container count/type, ICD, amount, remarks.
4. Click **Create consignment**.
5. All ten pipeline stages start at **Waiting**. Advance them from the Pipeline board or the detail **Pipeline** tab.
 - *Form hint*: "All pipeline stages start at Waiting. Advance them from the Kanban board."

D. Find a specific shipment

1. Open **Consignments**.
2. Narrow it down with **year tabs**, **All clients**, the status filter (**All statuses** / **Unreleased only** / **Stuck > 48h**), or type into **Search ref no...** and click **Search**. (Search also matches TANSAD, B/L,

client, vessel, EFD code, and IN REF.)

3. Click a row to open its detail.
4. If the job has an **IN REF** code, click the chip to open the **batch drawer** — it shows every sibling shipment, the totals, and a button to create one EFD for the whole batch.

E. Issue or link an EFD

1. Go to **EFD Records** → create new, or open a consignment → **+ New EFD** on the Overview tab.
2. Enter the EFD code and time, then link one or more consignments.
3. When you link consignments that share the same **IN REF**, client, and year, the app **automatically includes all batch siblings** — you don't have to link each B/L by hand.

F. Import historical Excel (admin/operator — usually once, at go-live)

1. Go to **Import** → **Import Excel Tracker**.
2. Choose a `.xlsx` file → **Preview** (shows **Parsing...** while it works).
3. Review the results:
 - **Errors** block a row from importing (e.g. a non-numeric REF No).
 - **Warnings** still import, but flag something to double-check (e.g. an odd amount, a padded REF No).
 - **Auto-create notices** tell you which new clients/ICDs will be created.
4. Click **Confirm import (N rows) (Committing...** while saving).
5. For very large loads, IT may use the CLI instead: `pnpm import:tracker path/to/file.xlsx` (dry-run by default; add `--commit` to actually write).

G. Run a management report

1. Open **Reports**.
2. Choose the report type, **year**, and **From/To** dates where the filter bar allows (some reports are year-only and show "Date range not applicable").
3. Click **Export XLSX** or **Export PDF** on the report header to download.

Report types: **Revenue Summary, Client Volume, Turnaround Time · by Client, Turnaround Time · by ICD, Pipeline Bottleneck, Pending Refunds.**

H. Admin-only corrections

- **Edit** — change fields on the edit form (respects column permissions).
- **Duplicate** — copy a consignment (handy for creating a GUTA "frames" record right after the "parts" one).
- **Delete** — a **soft delete** with a required **reason**; the row disappears from normal lists but is never truly destroyed.

- **Move to a different stage...** — in the stage menu; requires a **reason**; logged in the audit trail forever.

7. Screen reference

Dashboard

Your morning overview at a glance:

- **Released today** — jobs released today.
- **Pending release** — active jobs not yet released (links to the unreleased filter).
- **Stuck > 48h** — jobs in **Action** with no update for more than 48 hours.
- **Revenue · {month}** — service fees from releases this month.
- **Pipeline funnel** — how many jobs sit at each Action stage. A tall bar = a bottleneck (e.g. a pile-up at Assessment means the tax office is slow this week).
- **Arrivals this week** — vessels arriving Mon–Sun.
- **Overdue jobs** — the longest-stuck jobs, with stage and hours.

When nothing is stuck: **“Nothing is stuck right now.”**

Pipeline

Two views on desktop (**Kanban** | **Triage**); phones use **Triage** only (no Kanban tab on narrow screens).

Kanban — “Pipeline Board”

- Ten columns (Manifest → Release); one card per active consignment, sitting in its **current** stage’s column.
- Each card shows REF No, client, and key details.
- **New** button → create a consignment.
- A year selector controls which year’s jobs appear.

Triage — “Triage”

Three collapsible sections:

Section	Contents
Action Needed	Jobs being worked on; a STUCK badge appears if a stage has sat in Action 48+ hours
Waiting	Not started, or Awaiting arrival (no arrival date yet)
Done	Fully released jobs

Empty section: **"Nothing here."**

Action Inbox

- Heading: **Action Inbox**; the subtitle counts how many items need *you*.
- Grouped by stage name (Manifest, Shipping Batch, ...).
- Shows only consignments where a stage is **Action** *and* you have **write** permission on that stage column.
- Empty: **"All clear."**

Consignments

- **New consignment** button.
- Filters: year, client, status, search by REF No.
- Desktop: a full table. Mobile: a card list (REF, client, vessel, last updated).
- **IN REF** column (on large screens): click the batch chip to open the drawer.

Consignment detail

Tabs: **overview** · **pipeline** · **audit**

- **Overview**: core details, vessel & shipping info, **GUTA pair** indicator (if linked), **Linked EFD records**, and remarks.
- **Pipeline**: a linear list of all 10 stages with current values; an action menu on each incomplete stage.
- **Audit**: the full history of changes — when, who, which field, old → new. Includes **Row created** and **Forced stage change** events.

Header actions: **Duplicate**, **Edit**, **Delete** (admin).

EFD Records

List, search, and filter EFD codes. Flags include **PRIVATE**, **TRANSIT**, and **SHARED** (derived from the code and how many consignments are linked). Creating or linking may warn you if a consignment isn't released yet.

Import

Import Excel Tracker — upload a `TRACKER` -format `.xlsx` , preview, confirm. Uses the exact same parser as the CLI importer, so the app and the command line behave identically.

Reports

Filtered tables plus **Export XLSX** and **Export PDF**. Money and dates are formatted for spreadsheets (numeric TZS, real date cells in XLSX).

Settings (admin)

- **Users** — invite, assign roles, deactivate.
 - **Roles & Permissions** — the per-column read/write matrix for custom roles.
-

8. Special shipment types

Not every job is a plain container. The app knows about these special cases and helps you handle them correctly.

PRIVATE (imported cars)

A personal vehicle (e.g. "2015 Mazda CX-5") imported by an individual. Cars skip much of the TBS path, their EFD is flagged **PRIVATE**, and they should **not** be put on a business **IN REF** batch.

TRANSIT

Cargo that only passes *through* Tanzania on its way to a landlocked neighbour (Zambia, Malawi, Rwanda, ...). Because the goods aren't staying, local duty rules differ. These are flagged **TRANSIT**.

COIL (steel coils)

Heavy steel coils imported in bulk (e.g. by *Seiko*). They're counted by the **number of coils** (e.g. "319 coils"), not by container, and they go to the **DP World** terminal. The app warns you if a COIL job is assigned to any other yard.

GUTA parts and frames

KDL's biggest motorcycle client splits each batch across **two** Bills of Lading for shipping reasons:

- **GUTA PARTS** — several containers of engines, wheels, gears.
- **FRAMES** — one container of the structural chassis.

Parts and frames are useless apart, so they must clear **together**. The app auto-links the pair when their descriptions match (e.g. `073C - GUTA PARTS` and `073C - FRAMES`). If one side is **Released** and the other is not, a **red warning** appears on both detail pages so nobody ships half a motorcycle.

IN REF invoice batches

Several B/Ls for one client are often invoiced together under one code (e.g. `TZ3`). Use the **batch drawer** to see all siblings, total containers, total amount, and **Create EFD for this batch**. Linking an EFD to one member can auto-link the whole batch.

9. How the old Excel tracker worked (in detail)

This section is for anyone who never used the spreadsheet — and for understanding *exactly* what the app replaced. We'll use the real file (`TRACKER_--_KDL.xlsx`) as the example, because the import parser is built around its real-world quirks.

What the file was

- **Name:** `TRACKER_--_KDL.xlsx` (sometimes written with spaces: `TRACKER -- KDL.xlsx`).
- **One sheet, named** `IMPORT` , holding **every client and every stage for the whole company** — hundreds of rows per year (the sample file has 562 rows across 2025).
- **The single source of truth.** If it was wrong, the business was wrong.

How a single sheet was laid out

The sheet was *not* a clean database table. It mixed several kinds of rows together, top to bottom:

1. **A title row** — e.g. `import consignmet` in the top-left, mostly empty otherwise.
2. **A header row** — the column titles. These were hand-typed and full of inconsistencies (real examples from the file): `B/L No;` , `No. of Cont(s)` (with a line break inside the cell), `CURRENT STATUS` , `TANESWS Loading` , `ASSMENT` , `TBS Loading` , `Inspection file` . Spelling was never standardised.
3. **A year-separator row** — a row where the year (`2025`) was typed into many cells across the row, used purely as a visual divider between one year's jobs and the next. It carries no real data.
4. **Data rows** — one row per consignment, e.g. `1 | 9900001 | 1253895 | BREE AUTO | ... | Released | ... | PRIVATE` .
5. **Blank rows and footer rows** — scattered gaps and summary lines with no REF No.

Because everything lived in one grid, the only way to tell these row types apart was to *look* at them. The app's importer does this automatically (see "Importing that file today" below).

The real column order (left to right)

The actual sheet runs: **S/N** → **REF No** → **TANSAD No.** → **CLIENT** → **B/L No;** → **No. of Cont(s)** → **(container type)** → **ITEMS/GOODS** → **VESSEL** → **ARR. DATE** → **ICD** → then the ten pipeline columns **Manifest** → **Shipping Batch** → **CURRENT STATUS** → **TANESWS** → **ASSMENT** → **TBS Loading** → **TBS Debit** → **Manifest Comp** → **Duty status** → **Inspection file** → **Release status** → **Release Date** → then **EFD Code** → **EFD time** → **IN REF** → **AMOUNT** → **Remarks**.

Notice that the money (`AMOUNT`) and the invoice code (`IN REF`) sit near the *far right*, separated from everything else — easy to scroll past, easy to mis-edit.

The messy conventions the team relied on (and the app now handles)

Years of practical shortcuts were baked into the cells. The importer understands every one of them:

- **Dates as numbers.** Excel stores 45782 instead of a readable date. That number means “45,782 days since 30 Dec 1899” — i.e. an actual calendar date. The parser converts these serial numbers back into real dates.
- **Times as decimals.** The EFD time 0.5321296 is not a typo — it’s a fraction of a 24-hour day (0.5 = noon). The parser converts it to 12:46:16 .
- **Multiple EFD codes in one cell,** with a shorthand: 03429127, ..131 . The ..131 means “same as the previous code, but ending in 131” → 03429131 . The parser expands this automatically.
- **REF numbers padded with 9s.** Short numbers were padded to 7 digits starting with 99 . The parser pads short values and warns a human to verify.
- **GUTA pairs sharing an IN REF.** Rows like 072C - GUTA PARTS (TZ3, 300,000) and 072C - FRAMES (TZ3, 150,000) sit next to each other, sharing the TZ3 invoice code — the only link between them was that they were typed adjacently. The app turns this into a real, enforced relationship.
- **Free-text status and remarks.** Statuses were typed by hand (Uploaded , Done , Closed , Paid , Released), and Remarks held anything (PREPARED , PRIVATE , refund notes). Typos were silent.

How the team used it day to day

1. **New arrival** — insert a row; type a REF No, client, B/L, container info, vessel, arrival date, ICD.
2. **Progress** — manually overwrite each stage cell: Waiting → Action → Done / Paid / Closed / Released .
3. **Money & notes** — type the AMOUNT (TZS service fee) and any Remarks .
4. **Batch billing** — put the same IN REF on related rows; paste the EFD CODE (sometimes several, comma-separated, with .. shorthand).
5. **Finding problems** — scroll, eyeball, or colour cells by hand. There was **no automatic “stuck 48 hours” alert** — a stalled job was only noticed if someone happened to look.
6. **Management** — build pivot tables or copy ranges by hand for revenue and volume.

Excel column → app field (the mapping)

Excel header (as actually typed)	App field / table
S/N	serial_no
REF No	ref_no
TANSAD No.	tansad_no
CLIENT	clients.name
B/L No;	bl_number
No. of Cont(s)	container_count
(container type column)	container_type
ITEMS/GOODS	goods_description
VESSEL	vessel_name
ARR. DATE	arrival_date
ICD	icds.location
Manifest	manifest_status
Shipping Batch	shipping_batch_status
CURRENT STATUS	current_status
TANESWS Loading	tanews_status
ASSMENT	assessment_status
TBS Loading	tbs_loading_status
TBS Debit	tbs_debit_status
Manifest Comp	manifest_comp_status
Duty status	duty_status
Inspection file	inspection_file_status
Release status	release_status
Release Date	release_date
EFD Code	efd_records (one or many per cell)
EFD time	efd_time
IN REF	in_ref

Excel header (as actually typed)	App field / table
AMOUNT	amount
Remarks	remarks

Header matching is deliberately forgiving. The importer lowercases, strips dots and colons, and collapses spaces — so `ARR. DATE`, `ASSMENT`, `TANESWS Loading`, and `S/N` all map correctly *despite* the typos. It needs to find at least `REF No` plus a handful of other recognisable headers before it trusts a row as a real header.

Importing that file today

- **In the app: Import** → upload the `.xlsx` → **Preview** → **Confirm import**.
- **CLI (bulk):** `pnpm import:tracker ./TRACKER_--_KDL.xlsx` (preview/dry-run by default; add `--commit` to write).
- The parser handles Excel date serials, decimal EFD times, multi-code EFD cells with `..` shorthand, padded REF numbers, and lowercase status values (`paid` , `closed`) — surfacing anything questionable as a warning rather than silently guessing.

Note: The app's report exports are *structured reports* (revenue, funnel, turnaround), not a pixel-perfect clone of the old tracker layout. The goal is better answers, not a copy of the old grid.

10. Using the app on mobile and tablet

KDL Tracker is a **responsive website**, not a native App Store app. You need internet and a login. It reshapes itself to fit the screen:

Screen width	Navigation	Pipeline	Lists	Stage actions
Phone (< 768px)	Hamburger menu	Triage default (no Kanban tab)	Card lists	Bottom drawer
Tablet/desktop (≥ 768px)	Fixed sidebar	Kanban default; optional Triage tab	Full tables	Popover menu

Triage on mobile (your main field workflow)

1. Open **Pipeline** — you see **Triage** with year pills and a **New** button.
2. Expand **Action Needed** — handle **STUCK** rows first.
3. Tap a row → drawer with **Mark...**, **Set to Action**, and **Open detail** →.
4. **Waiting** holds jobs not started or without an arrival date.

5. **Done** holds fully released jobs.

Practical tips

- Bookmark the site on your home screen for quick access (it still opens in the browser).
- **Inbox** and **Consignments** use easy-to-tap cards on small screens.
- **EFD Records** is still table-oriented on mobile — usable, but less polished than Consignments.

What mobile does *not* do

- No offline mode and no installable PWA today — you need a connection.
- No Kanban drag-and-drop on phones (by design — too cramped; use Triage taps instead).
- Stuck-job **email alerts** are built but may not be deployed in your environment yet — ask your admin.

11. App vs Excel — the same shipment, two ways

The clearest way to see the upgrade is to follow **one real shipment** through both systems.

Example: consignment 9900003 — TZ CHINA, B/L GOSUNGB20487547, 5 × 40FT of 072C - GUTA PARTS, on vessel KOTA MEGAH, to African ICD, invoice batch TZ3, fee 300,000 TZS — together with its frames sibling 9900004 (072C - FRAMES, 150,000 TZS, same TZ3).

In the old Excel sheet

1. Someone inserts two rows and hand-types both, hoping the TZ3 code matches on both.
2. To advance a stage, they overwrite a cell — say change Action to Done. **No record** of who did it or when.
3. If the parts (9900003) get released but the frames (9900004) stall, **nothing warns anyone**. The mistake surfaces only when the angry client calls.
4. To bill the batch, someone manually copies one EFD code into both rows (and may fat-finger it).
5. To find out if anything is stuck, someone scrolls 300 rows and eyeballs the colours.
6. If two people open the file at once, one person's edits can silently overwrite the other's.

In KDL Tracker

1. You create 9900003, set its IN REF to TZ3, then **Duplicate** it for the frames — the batch link is real, not a coincidence of typing.
2. You advance a stage by dragging a card or tapping a button. Every change is **stamped with who, what, old→new, and when** in the audit log — automatically.
3. The moment parts and frames fall out of sync, **both detail pages flash a red GUTA warning**.

4. You create **one EFD for the whole TZ3 batch** — it auto-links every sibling.
5. The **Dashboard** and **Triage** surface stuck jobs on their own; you don't hunt for them.
6. Many people work at once; the database resolves conflicts and Realtime updates everyone's screen live.

Upgrades — why the app is better

Area	Excel tracker	KDL Tracker
Multiple users	One safe editor at a time; overwrite risk	Many users at once; database handles conflicts; live updates
Security	Anyone with the file edits anything, including money	Login, roles, optional per-column permissions
History	No record of who changed what	Full audit tab on every consignment
Stuck jobs	Manual scanning, by eye	Dashboard tile, Stuck > 48h , Triage STUCK badge, Inbox
Order of stages	Any cell editable in any order	Database blocks impossible sequences
Backward moves	Silent, anytime, by anyone	Admin-only, requires a reason, logged forever
IN REF / EFD batches	Copy-paste conventions	Batch drawer; auto-link siblings when creating an EFD
GUTA pairs	Easy to release one side only	Red warning the instant parts/frames diverge
Reporting	Manual pivot tables	Reports screen + Export XLSX/PDF in seconds
Data entry quirks	Typos and <code>..131</code> shorthand are silent	Importer expands shorthand and warns on anything odd
Alerts	None	Email digest for stuck jobs (when deployed)
Search	Filter rows in one sheet	Search REF/TANSAD/B/L/client/vessel/EFD/IN REF + filters

Trade-offs — where Excel still feels simpler

The app is a big upgrade, but honesty matters. A few things genuinely felt easier in Excel:

Area	Excel tracker	KDL Tracker
Learning curve	Staff already knew it	New UI, login, and concepts (roles, stages) to learn
Offline	Works on a laptop with no internet	Needs a network connection
Free editing	Change any cell, anytime	Pipeline rules; backward moves are admin-only
Whole-sheet view	Hundreds of rows/columns visible at once	Paginated lists; use filters instead
Ad-hoc notes across rows	Easy to paste blocks anywhere	Remarks per row; less like a free grid
Backup	Copy the file to a USB stick or email	Depends on cloud backups (admin-managed)
Export shape	The exact tracker layout	Reports are summaries, not a clone of the old sheet
Cost	Excel was already licensed	Hosting and maintenance

Bottom line: Use **Import** *once* to bring history into the database, then run day-to-day work only in the app. Keep a read-only archive of the old `.xlsx` if policy requires it — but never treat it as the live system again.

12. For developers

Quick start

```
pnpm install
pnpm dev
```

Open <http://localhost:3000>. Configure `.env.local` with the Supabase URL and keys (see your team admin or `humanTasks.md`).

Common commands

Command	Purpose
<code>pnpm dev</code>	Development server
<code>pnpm typecheck</code>	TypeScript check
<code>pnpm lint</code>	ESLint
<code>pnpm test</code>	Unit tests (Vitest)
<code>pnpm build</code>	Production build
<code>pnpm import:tracker <file></code>	CLI Excel import (dry-run by default; <code>--commit</code> to write)

Project docs

File	Contents
<code>PRD.md</code>	Product requirements and business rules (frozen at v1)
<code>doc.md</code>	Extended guide + technical architecture
<code>status.md</code>	Current build phase and what's shipped
<code>CLAUDE.md</code>	Conventions for contributors
<code>decisions.md</code>	Numbered log of non-PRD design decisions

Stack: Next.js 16, React 19, Tailwind 4, TypeScript, Supabase (Postgres + Auth + Realtime + Storage).

Welcome aboard

- **Operators:** Start with **Dashboard**, then **Inbox** and **Pipeline** (Triage on your phone).
- **Admins:** Watch **Dashboard** and **Reports**; manage access under **Settings**.
- **New interns:** Read sections 1–3 for shipping context, then section 6 for hands-on steps.

Questions? Ask a senior teammate or your administrator. </content> </invoke>